Elicitation Plan: Customer Outage Request (Illustrative Case Study)

This plan describes how requirements for the outage scenario would be gathered and confirmed. It is illustrative: it shows the approach, and no real sessions were held. It builds on the draft requirements document and the BPMN, ERD and API artifacts.

1. Objective and scope

Objective: confirm the draft requirements, resolve the open questions, and agree priorities with the people who run and use the process.

Open questions to resolve (from section 11 of the requirements document):

ID	Open question
OQ-1	How is the SLA defined: time to respond, or time to restore service?
OQ-2	What does the dispatcher decide after escalation, and how is it recorded?
OQ-3	Should work be creatable directly on a technician, and with which checks?
OQ-4	Are spare parts and inventory in scope, and at what level of detail?

2. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Influence	What we need from them	Main technique
Service manager	High	SLA definition, priorities, performance targets	Interview, workshop
Dispatcher	High	How work is assigned, escalation handling, daily pain points	Observation, interview
Technician	Medium	Field constraints, status updates, missing-part handling	Interview, observation
Customer (representative)	Medium	How problems are reported, expected updates, confirmation	Survey, interview
Development team lead	Medium	Interfaces, authentication, performance and integration limits	Interface analysis, interview

3. Techniques by phase

Phase	Goal	Technique	Participants	Output
1. Discovery	Understand the current process and goals	Document analysis, interviews	Service manager, dispatcher	Process notes, confirmed scope, answer to OQ-1
2. Detail	Capture exceptions and real behavior	Observation (job shadowing), interviews	Dispatcher, technician	Exception list, answers to OQ-2 and OQ-4
3. Rules and data	Make rules and data precise	Business rules workshop, data analysis (SQL on past activities), interface analysis	Dispatcher, service manager, development lead	Confirmed rules, data needs, answer to OQ-3
4. Validation	Check that the model matches reality	Prototype review (Figma screen), BPMN walkthrough, MoSCoW prioritization workshop	All stakeholders	Corrected models, prioritized requirements
5. Confirmation	Agree the final set	Document review, sign-off	Service manager, dispatcher, development lead	Approved requirements

4. Key questions by stakeholder

Service manager

- Does the SLA measure time to respond or time to restore service? What happens when it is breached? (OQ-1)
- Which measures matter most: SLA compliance, first-time fix, customer confirmation rate?
- What are acceptable response times for the system (NFR-1)?

Dispatcher

- After an escalation, how do you choose a technician and what do you record? (OQ-2)
- What information is usually missing when work is escalated?
- How often are valid requests left unmatched for 30 minutes?

Technician

- What most often blocks a repair, and how is a missing part handled? (OQ-4)
- How and when do you update the status of a job, and what if there is no connection?

Customer representative

- How do you report an outage today, and what updates do you expect?
- What does "confirmed" mean to you: a call, a message, a click?

Development team lead

- Which interfaces and authentication methods are available today?
- Can work be created directly on a technician, and where should the skill be checked? (OQ-3)

5. Schedule (illustrative)

Session	Phase	Duration	Participants
1. Goals and SLA interview	1	45 min	Service manager
2. Dispatcher interview	1, 2	60 min	Dispatcher
3. Dispatcher shadowing	2	2 hours	Dispatcher
4. Technician interview	2	45 min	Technician
5. Business rules and interface workshop	3	90 min	Dispatcher, service manager, development lead
6. Validation workshop (prototype and BPMN)	4	90 min	All stakeholders
7. Requirements review and sign-off	5	60 min	Service manager, dispatcher, development lead

A short customer survey runs in parallel with sessions 1 to 4.

6. Preparation checklist

- Objectives and an agenda per session, with the questions from section 4
- Materials: the BPMN diagram, ERD, draft requirements and the Figma prototype
- Pre-reading sent two days before workshops
- Agreement to take notes and, where allowed, record
- A clear owner for each open question

7. Documentation and follow-up

- Notes are written within 24 hours and sent to participants for confirmation.
- Every new or changed requirement gets an ID and a source (session and stakeholder), and is added to the traceability table.
- An issues log tracks open questions and decisions with owner and date.
- Conflicting views are recorded and resolved in the validation workshop, not by assumption.

8. Risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Key stakeholders have little time	Short, focused sessions; asynchronous questions for follow-up
Dispatcher and manager disagree on priorities	Joint workshop with MoSCoW prioritization and a named decision-maker
Stated process differs from actual practice	Observation and analysis of past activity data, not interviews alone
Scope grows during sessions	Compare each request with the scope in section 1 of the requirements document; park extras in the issues log

9. Success criteria

- All four open questions are answered and recorded.
- Every user story has acceptance criteria that its stakeholders have reviewed.
- The requirements are prioritized and approved by the service manager, dispatcher and development lead.